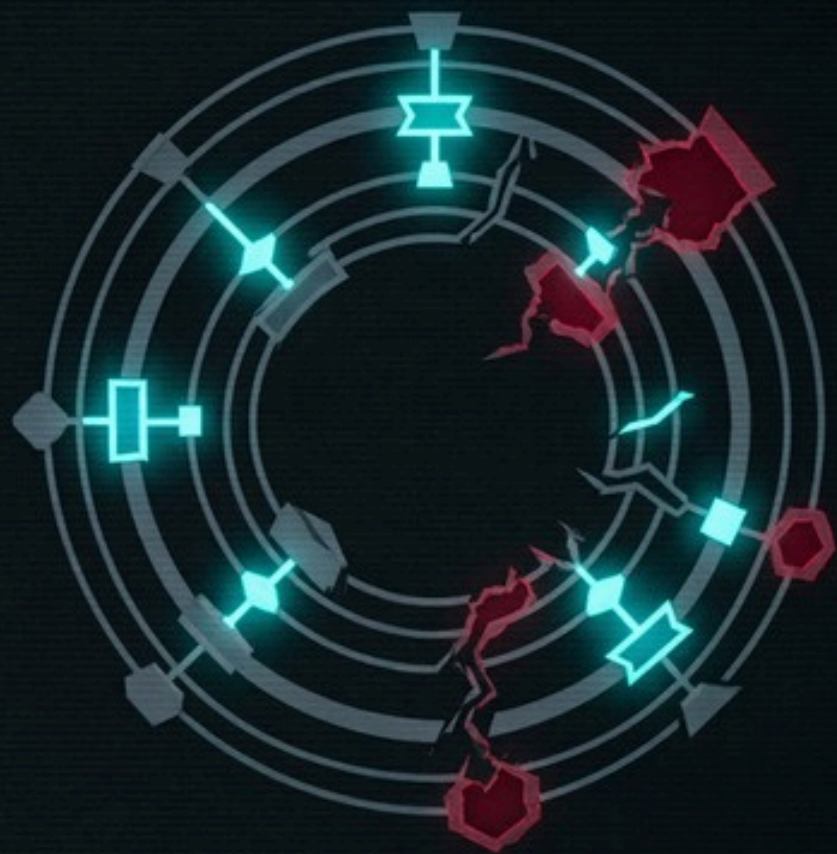
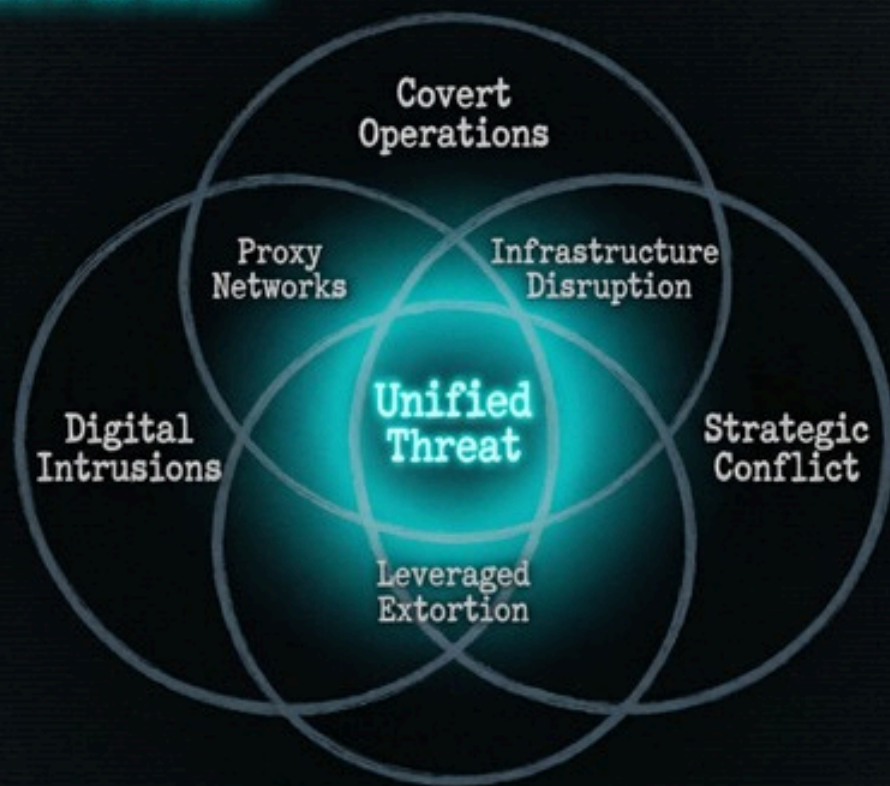


The New Paradigm of Cyber Warfare

Geopolitics, APTs, and
the Shift to Cyber Resilience



One Continuum



Cyber domains collapse into one spectrum

State and syndicate actors share tools across a borderless spectrum where attribution fails.

Covert Operations

Nation-states pre-position AI-driven asymmetries to achieve plausible deniability and unprecedented scale.

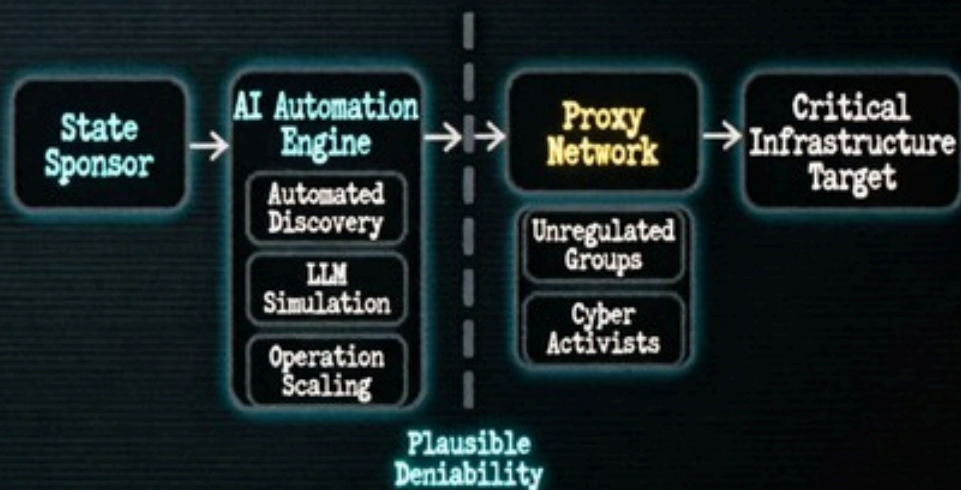
Powers shift to dormant access

Dormant nodes in critical infra



AI and proxies scale operations

Volume of hundreds, deniable

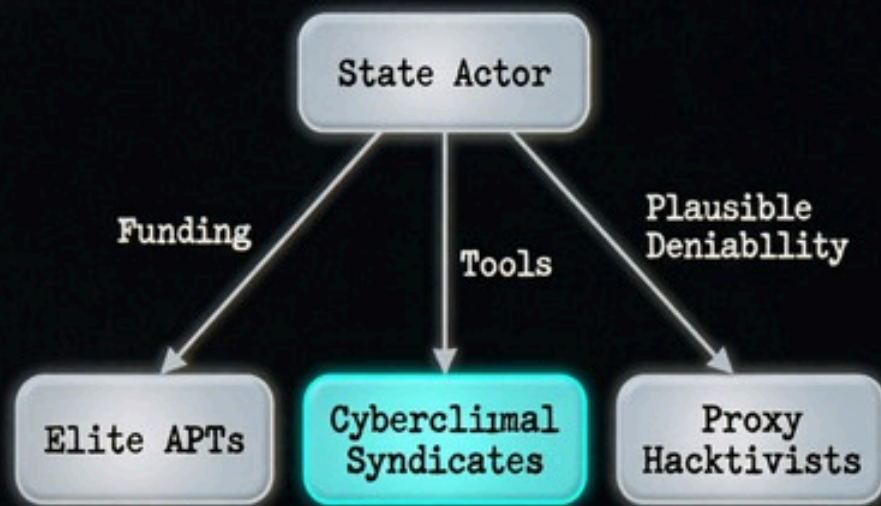


Pre-Positioning & AI Asymmetry

Nation-states pre-position AI-driven asymmetries to achieve plausible deniability and unprecedented scale.

Build no in-house armies

Buy access; outsource attribution



Layered delegation and blurred traces

Attribution fails as attacks scale



No One Shield

Each runs a distinct playbook

Uniform defence fails all four.

Actor A acquires IP. Actor B disrupts infrastructure.

Actor C deploys eraser tools.
Actor D generates revenue via cyber operations.

Six months of proof.

Four cases, zero overlap.

Overt and Disruptive

ACTOR B

Disruption and Interruption
energy grids
government networks
logistics

proxy activists and eraser tools
Polish grid ~30 sites

ACTOR C

Response and Realignment
defense contractors
regional adversaries

erasers and access-and-disclose
Stryker 200K devices across 79 countries

Covert and Persistent

ACTOR A

Intelligence Gathering and IP Acquisition

intellectual property
critical infrastructure
advanced manufacturing
stealthy Living-off-the-Land TTPs
UNC3886 accessed 4 telecom operators

ACTOR D

State-Sponsored Cyber Operations

cryptocurrency exchanges
financial institutions
elite cyber operations group
Lazarus \$30.4M Upbit unauthorized transfer

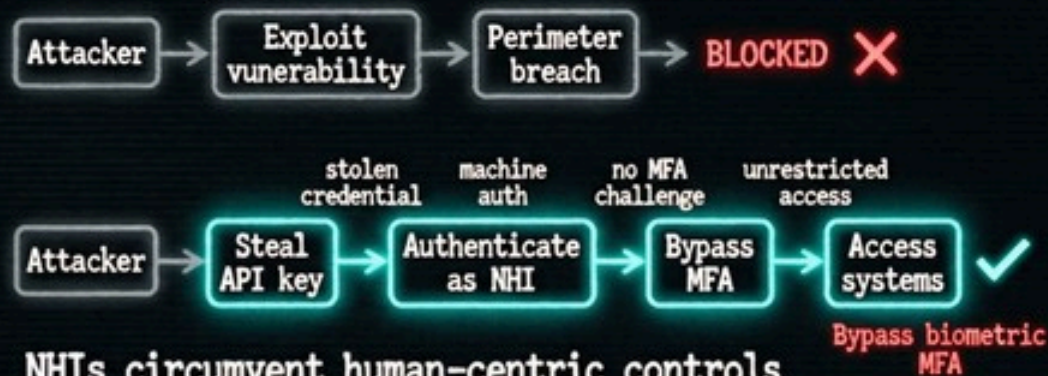
Great-Power Competition

Asymmetric Regional Actor

Attackers bypass Zero-Trust by hijacking non-human identities to log in rather than break in.

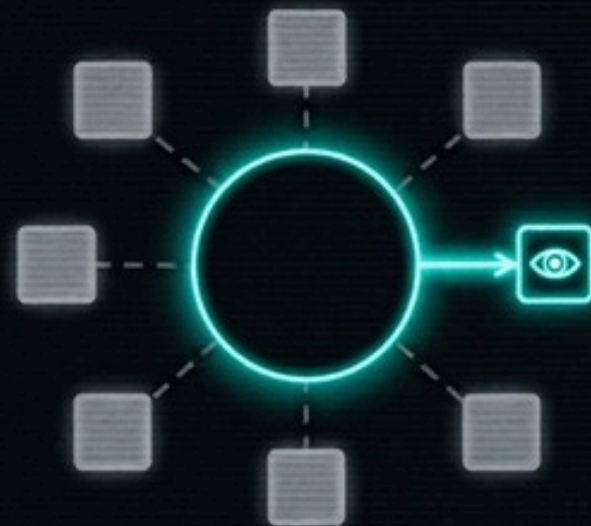
Attackers log in, not break in

Stolen keys bypass MFA.



Silent lateral movement

NHIs roam laterally, unseen.

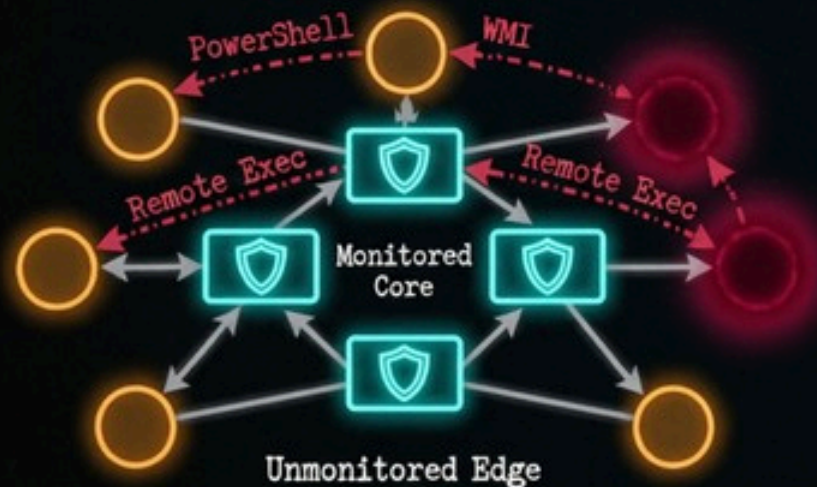


Core (Monitored) Edge Blindspots (Unmonitored)

Hackers live off the land and exploit unmonitored edge devices to remain invisible inside the network.

Living off the Land

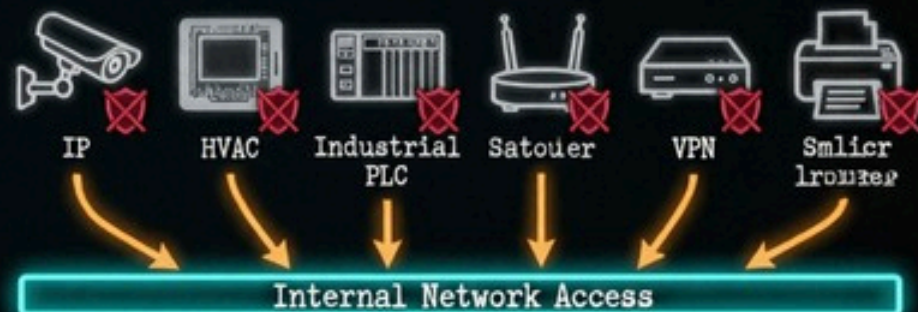
Native tools bypass EDR detection



🛡️ = EDR-protected ○ = agentless device
= muted silver = alive = attacker path

Agentless Edge Devices

Edge devices cannot run EDR agents



Coercion to Conflict

Encrypt, expose, then interrupt



Financial Loss

Geopolitical
Disruption

Motive Shifts to Global Strategy
Strategic leverage via coercion.

Grid Sabotage

Kinetic Strike

Cyber access, kinetic sabotage



Attack Chain

Dec 2025–Jan 2026: ~30 sites



Reset to Zero

C-suite executives and board members responsible for enterprise risk and geopolitical strategy

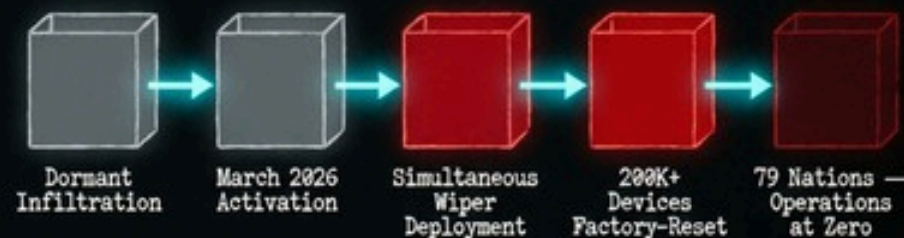
Wipers destroy data

Production halts permanently.
Muted Silver



Handala wipes 200K

200K devices wiped in 79 nations.
Muted Silver



200K Wiped

Lazarus and UNC3886 illustrate how state-funded syndicates blur the line between profit-driven theft and strategic disruption.

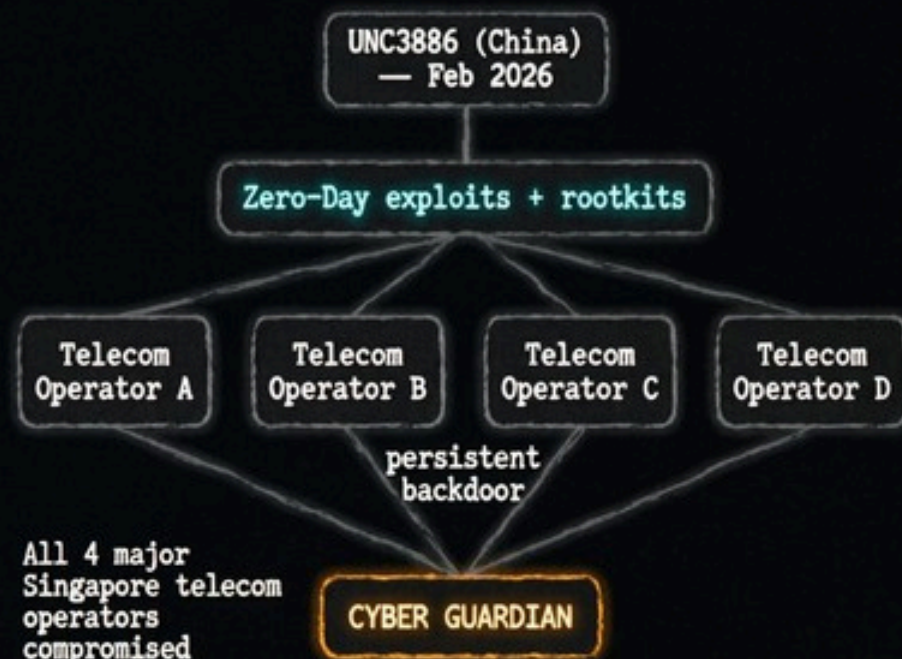
Lazarus dual ops

Stole \$30.4M; hit 3 defense firms



UNC3886 owns infra

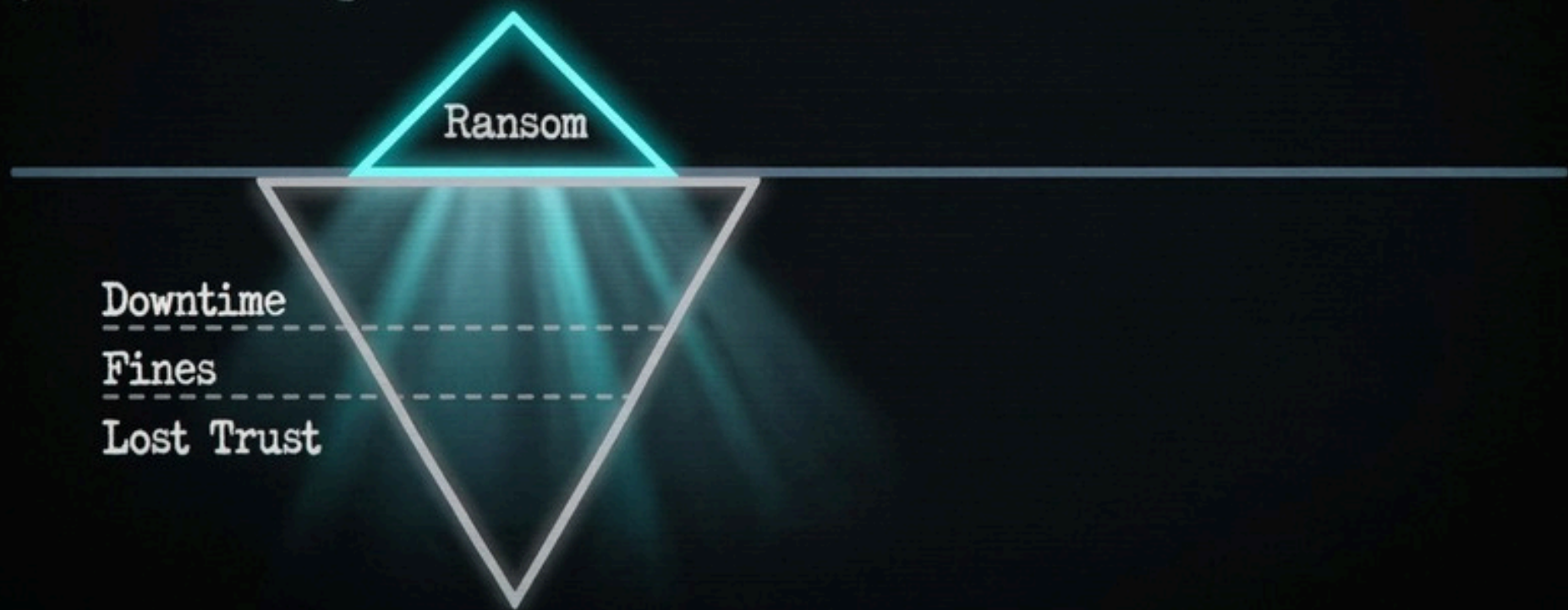
4 Singapore telcos compromised



The True Cost of a Breach

Ransom reveals only the tip

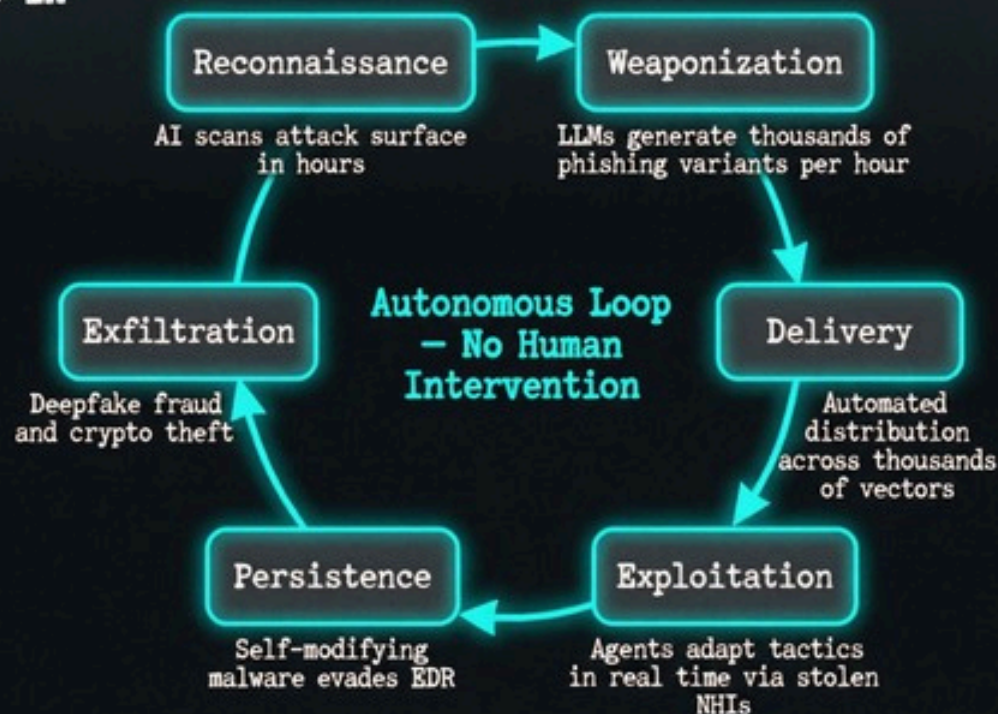
Downtime, fines, and lost trust form the submerged mass dwarfing prevention budgets.



AI Outruns Us

Autonomous Attack Loop

Malware adapts in real time



Minutes vs. Days

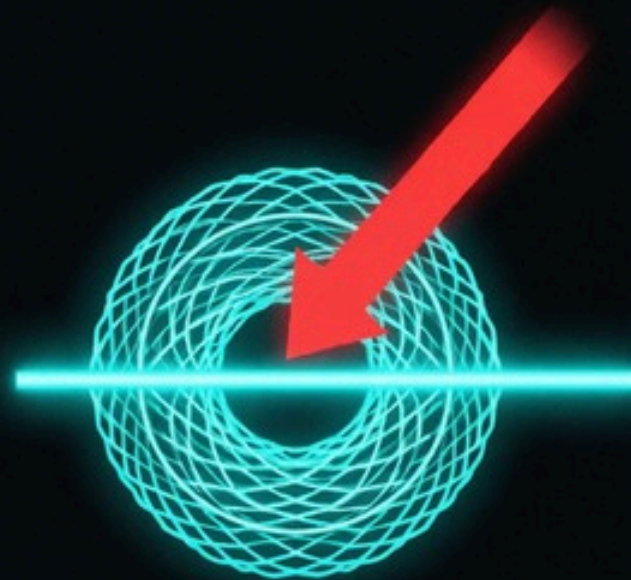
Data stolen before humans respond

Callout Kill chain in minutes

Resilience Wins

Build shock absorbers

Walls shatter under
nation-state strikes.
Shock absorbers
sustain degraded-mode
continuity.



Resilience Wins

Perimeter walls always break. Shock absorbers keep ops running.

Build three pillars of **survival**: Assume breach, sustain, recover.

